

CALRIG · CALCULATION

CalRig sizing calculations

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.1	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	First issue for TRL 3 (geometry and mass, heat balance with a thermoelectric model, moisture and condensation, control stability, bay uniformity, reference uncertainty, particle decay, CO2, throughput, power, cost)

CalRig sizing calculations

On paper, CalRig meets ten of its eighteen requirements, has three at risk, misses four and has one that cannot be checked at TRL 3. The four misses are R2 (humidity: the rig cannot hold 85 % RH at 20 °C in the reference room, because the inner Peltier sink runs below the dew point and condenses water about ten times faster than the bubbler supplies it), R8 (particle traceability needs a collocation site that is still to be named), R12 (parts cost about \$404 against the \$300 budget, and \$4 over the \$400 recommended in the TRL 2 review) and R13 (mass about 13.4 kg against 12 kg; the footprint and height now fit). The three at risk are R4 (bay uniformity at cold set points), R5 (reference temperature uncertainty, which depends on an uncertified sensor tolerance) and R6 (reference humidity uncertainty, 2.0 % RH against a 2 % RH target). R1 is met against the relaxed target adopted under DDR-001: 8.9 °C is reachable in a 25 °C room and 13.3 °C in a 30 °C room.

The calculations changed four parts of the TRL 2 concept: the jacket now covers the bottom and the right-hand wall as well; the mixing fan grows from 80 mm to 120 mm; the bubbler jar gets a foam sleeve, a smaller fill and a trace-heated outlet line; and the base plate is trimmed to 600 x 500 mm with the chamber moved so the aerosol valve stays on it. Every number in this note is printed by `docs/04-calcs/sizing.py`; the tag in brackets, for example [B4], is the line of that script's output that carries it.

Safety: These are first-principles estimates for a paper proof of concept. They do not replace checks of the thermal cut-offs, the fuse rating or the smoke clearance on a built rig. See CLR-PRC-001, Safety.

■ Scope and method

The note checks every requirement in CLR-REQ-001 v0.3 against the design in CLR-PRC-001 v0.3 and the parametric model `cad/src/model.py`. The script imports the model's `PARAMS`, derived dimensions and part solids, so the chamber size, jacket, bay layout, footprint and mass are those of the STEP files and drawing CLR-DWG-001. It also reads `bom/bom.csv` and `budget_usd` in `project.yaml`. Run it from the repo root with `python docs/04-calcs/sizing.py`.

The design case is the reference room of CLR-REQ-001 (22 °C, 50 % RH) with the R1 room range of 15 to 30 °C, the four US EPA enhanced set points (20 °C and 40 °C at 40 % and 85 % RH), six sensor heads at the largest size in R10 and the insulated door panel fitted.

■ Assumptions

Table 1. Main assumptions.

Area	Assumption	Basis
Films	Inside 10 W/(m ² ·K) (fan-stirred); outside 8 W/(m ² ·K) (still room, with radiation)	Typical values
Materials	Acrylic k 0.19 W/(m·K), 1,190 kg/m ³ , 1,470 J/(kg·K); XPS k 0.034 W/(m·K), 35 kg/m ³ ; foam sleeve k 0.035 W/(m·K); plywood 550 kg/m ³	Handbook values
Thermal bridges	Edges, gasket, cable gland and fixings add 20 % to the jacketed wall conductance	Allowance
Air paths	Conditioning loop 3 L/min, closed from and back to the chamber, returning at room temperature; HEPA loop 20 L/min full, 5 L/min slow, H13 (99.95 %); gasket leak 0.1 air changes per hour	Design values
Internal gains	Mixing fan 2.4 W, inner Peltier fan 1.5 W, six heads at 0.4 W, references 0.4 W: 6.7 W [B3]	Typical fan and sensor draw; up from 4 W at TRL 2
Thermoelectric module	One 12706-class module: V _{max} 15.2 V, I _{max} 6.0 A, ΔT _{max} 66 K at 300 K; derived Seebeck 50.7 mV/K, resistance 1.98 Ω, conductance 0.54 W/K [A0]	Typical datasheet values, to confirm for the chosen assembly
Heat sinks	Outer sink with 92 mm fan 0.25 K/W; inner sink with fan 0.45 K/W	Typical air-to-air assembly
Supply	12 V; the module voltage is limited to 12 V	Certified external supply
Moisture	Water diffusivity in PMMA 1 × 10 ⁻¹² m ² /s, uptake 2 % by mass at 100 % RH, linear in RH; bubbler air leaves at 90 % saturation; silica gel holds 5 % by mass at low RH and delivers about 5 % RH air	Literature order of magnitude; to confirm
Aerosol	Incense smoke, deposition 0.2 per hour in a stirred chamber	Order of magnitude for sub-micron smoke
Reference sensors	SHT45 ±0.1 °C and ±1.0 % RH typical (Sensirion); a 0.2 °C tolerance is also checked because no certificate is bought; hysteresis 0.8 % RH	Datasheet typical values; the maximum figures and hysteresis are assumptions until the full datasheet is read

■ A. Geometry, capacity, size and mass (R10, R13)

The chamber is 400 x 300 x 300 mm inside (36.0 L) in a 412 x 312 x 312 mm acrylic shell [A1]. The tray is 318 x 176 mm with six 90 x 70 mm bays and 244 mm of clear height above it, so six heads at the R10 maximum of 90 x 70 x 50 mm fit, with the reference cluster behind and above them [A2]. R10 is met.

With the chamber moved toward +X and the base trimmed, the whole rig, including the aerosol valve, the Peltier fan, the conditioning column and the salt jars, fits 600 x 500 mm and is 374 mm high [A3]. Adding the bottom jacket panel raised the chamber by 25 mm, which is still within the 400 mm limit. The mass is about 13.4 kg: 4.9 kg of acrylic, 2.0 kg of plywood base, 0.7 kg of XPS and about 5.8 kg of bought-in parts. R13 is **not met** on mass, by about 1.4 kg. Carrying the power supply and salt jars separately (about 1.2 kg) brings the rig itself to about 12.2 kg; thinner acrylic or an HDPE base would close the rest, but both are design changes left for Amish (see `docs/REVIEW.md`).

■ B. Heat balance and temperature range (R1, R16)

With every face except the door jacketed, the wall conductance is $1.01 \text{ W}/(\text{m}^2 \cdot \text{K})$; the clear door is $3.90 \text{ W}/(\text{m}^2 \cdot \text{K})$ and the door with its panel $1.01 \text{ W}/(\text{m}^2 \cdot \text{K})$ [B1]. The total chamber conductance with the panel fitted is 0.82 W/K , of which 0.06 W/K is the conditioning loop; with the panel off it is 1.17 W/K [B2]. The TRL 2 estimate of about 1.0 W/K is therefore about right, but internal gains are larger than assumed (6.7 W against 4 W) [B3].

The Peltier module is modeled with its Seebeck, Joule and conduction terms, both sink resistances and the 12 V limit, and solved for the lowest chamber temperature it can hold at full drive.

Table 2. Lowest chamber temperature at full drive, door panel fitted [B4].

Room	Lowest chamber temperature	Module	Outer sink
15 °C	0.1 °C	4.97 A, 12.0 V, 60 W	35 °C
22 °C	6.3 °C	4.94 A, 12.0 V, 59 W	42 °C
25 °C	8.9 °C	4.92 A, 12.0 V, 59 W	45 °C
30 °C	13.3 °C	4.90 A, 12.0 V, 59 W	50 °C

Holding 10 °C in a 25 °C room takes 19.1 W of cooling at 3.95 A , 9.7 V and 38 W , with the inner sink near 1.4 °C [B5]. Heating is easy: 40 °C in a 15 °C room needs 13.9 W at about 9 W electrical, against a heating capacity of about 68 W at 12 V [B6]. The revised R1 (10 to 40 °C in rooms of 15 to 25 °C , with the lowest point stated for warmer rooms) is therefore **met**, with a 1.1 K margin at 25 °C . In a 30 °C room the lowest set point is about 13 °C , close to the TRL 2 estimate of 15 °C .

The lumped heat capacity is about 8.6 kJ/K , mostly the acrylic, and the passive time constant is 2.9 h [B7]. At full drive the chamber goes from 20 to 40 °C in about 36 min , but from 40 to 20 °C in about 91 min , and reaching 10 °C in a 25 °C room takes about 3.7 h because the margin is small [B8]. Sweeps should run from cold to hot, and 10 °C points are a separate, slower run.

The outer sink stays at or below 50 °C in normal use, 20 K under the 70 °C hot-side cut-off; the inner sink reaches about 46 °C when heating to 40 °C in a 15 °C room, and the 50 °C air cut-off is 10 K above the top set point [J2]. R16 is met.

■ C. Moisture, condensation and the conditioners (R2)

Going from 20 to 85 % RH at 40 °C needs 1.19 g of water in the air and about 0.59 g taken up by the acrylic surface in 45 min , 1.8 g in all [C1]. With the loop time constant of 12 min and bubbler air at 43 °C and 90 % saturation, the chamber reaches 85 % RH in about 26 min [C2]. Drying to 20 % RH at 20 °C from room air takes about 22 min [C3]. The 500 g of silica gel holds about 25 g at low RH, enough for about 12 sweeps between regenerations [C4].

The bubbler needs two changes. A bare 500 mL jar at 43 °C loses 7.7 W in a 22 °C room, and evaporation takes another 2.7 W , which is more than the 10 W pad can give; a 10 mm foam sleeve cuts the loss to 2.4 W , and with a 0.3 L fill the pad warms the water in about 50 min , so it is preheated during the 20 °C points [C5]. Air from the bubbler also condenses in a room-temperature line: a foam-lagged 200 mm line would deliver it at about 28 °C , well below its 41 °C dew point, so the line needs a small trace heater, about 1.1 W to hold 45 °C (3 W is allowed in the BOM) [C6].

Door condensation. At 40 °C and 85 % RH the dew point is 37.0 °C. In a 22 °C room the clear door face runs at 33.0 °C and condenses; with the door panel it runs at 38.2 °C, a 1.2 K margin. In a 15 °C room the margin falls to 0.5 K [C7]. The door panel (adopted under DDR-001) is required, and the hot, humid point is at risk in cold rooms.

Peltier sink condensation (R2 not met). At 20 °C and 85 % RH the dew point is 17.4 °C. Holding 20 °C in a 22 °C room still needs 8.3 W of cooling, mostly to remove the internal gains, and puts the inner sink at about 16.2 °C, 1.2 K below the dew point. The sink stays dry only in rooms below about 19 °C [C8]. It would condense about 7.7 g/h, while the bubbler, only 3 K warmer than the chamber at this point, supplies about 0.7 g/h, so 85 % RH at 20 °C cannot be held in the reference room [C9]. R2 is **not met**. An inner sink of about 0.20 K/W (a larger fin block with the same fan) would stay dry in rooms up to about 28 °C [C9]; this change is proposed in the review note, not made here. Cold points below the dew point will also wet the sink, so a drip tray and drain are needed in any case.

■ D. Stability at a set point (R3)

A lumped plant with a PI controller, a 20 s transport delay, a 4 s sensor lag, an 8-bit drive and a room swinging ± 1 K over 30 min holds the chamber within ± 0.02 K [D1]. At 40 °C and 85 % RH that temperature term is worth 0.10 % RH; with an assumed ± 1 % RH from the wet and dry mixing control, the humidity stability is about ± 1.0 % RH [D2]. R3 is met on this idealized model, which does not include mixing inside the chamber or the sink's own lag; the chamber log planned for TRL 4 is the real check.

■ E. Uniformity across the bays (R4)

The bay-to-bay temperature span is estimated as half the chamber load divided by the heat capacity rate of the mixing air, with the fan delivering 40 % of its free-air flow through the tray region. With the 80 mm fan of the TRL 2 concept the span is 0.61 K at 40 °C, 0.62 K at 20 °C and 1.42 K at 10 °C in a 25 °C room; with a 120 mm fan it falls to 0.36, 0.37 and 0.84 K [E1]. The 120 mm fan is therefore adopted in the model and BOM. That gives ± 0.18 °C at the EPA set points, within the ± 0.3 °C target, but ± 0.42 °C at 10 °C. The humidity spread from temperature at 40 °C and 85 % RH is ± 0.8 % RH [E2]. R4 is **at risk**: met at the EPA set points on a coarse estimate, not met at the cold end.

■ F. Reference uncertainty (R5, R6)

Table 3. Reference temperature uncertainty budget (standard uncertainties, °C) [F1].

Component	Value
Ice point realization (crushed ice and water)	0.02
SHT45 tolerance after the ice-point offset, 0 to 40 °C (0.1 °C, rectangular)	0.058
Drift between monthly checks (0.03 °C, rectangular)	0.017
Resolution and noise	0.01
Gradient from the reference mast to a bay (0.05 °C, rectangular)	0.029
Expanded, k = 2	0.14

With the typical 0.1 °C tolerance the expanded uncertainty is 0.14 °C, inside the 0.2 °C target; if the tolerance is 0.2 °C, as a maximum specification would allow, it is 0.24 °C [F1]. R5 is **at risk** until a second fixed point or a certified probe pins down the slope.

For humidity, the components are the salt fixed point itself (0.14 % RH), a 0.2 K gradient in the jar at 85 % RH (0.59), hysteresis (0.46), interpolation between fixed points (0.29) and use away from 25 °C (0.58) [F2]. The expanded uncertainty is 2.0 % RH [F3], at the 2 % RH target with no margin. R6 is **at risk**. The jar gradient and temperature terms dominate, so thermally lagged jars and fixed points taken at the chamber temperature would help most.

■ G. Particles (R7, R8)

With the HEPA loop at 20 L/min, the chamber cleans from 35 to 2 µg/m³ in about 5 min, and the gasket leak holds a floor of about 0.17 µg/m³ in a 15 µg/m³ room [G1]. At 5 L/min the decay from 300 to 5 µg/m³ takes about 28 min, 29 min without deposition, so wall losses barely matter. The 300 µg/m³ start needs about 10.8 µg of smoke, which a 60 mL syringe delivers if the plume in the cup is above 0.18 mg/m³ [G2]. R7 is met. R8 is **not met** by the rig alone: the transfer SPS30 still needs a collocation site, which remains open for Amish.

■ H. CO2 (R9)

Recirculating the chamber through soda lime at 3 L/min brings it to 50 ppm in about 25 min, with a leak floor of about 8 ppm; one liter of breath at 4 % CO₂ then adds about 1,081 ppm, and the SCD30 reference is good to about ±60 ppm at 1,000 ppm [H1]. R9 is met by calculation and datasheet.

■ I. Throughput (R11)

For the four EPA points, run cold to hot, each point settles for the longer of its temperature ramp and humidity change, then allows 15 min for the heads to equilibrate and holds for 30 min: 20 °C and 40 % RH 22 + 15 + 30 min; 20 °C and 85 % RH 26 + 15 + 30 min; 40 °C and 85 % RH 36 + 15 + 30 min; 40 °C and 40 % RH 22 + 15 + 30 min [I1]. The sweep takes about 4.8 h and the particle run about 49 min, 5.6 h in all [I2]. R11 is met, though the 20 °C, 85 % RH point only holds in a cool room (section C).

■ J. Power (R15)

The peak load is about 89 W: the Peltier at 59 W, bubbler heater 10 W, line trace 3 W, pumps 4 W, fans 6 W, HEPA blower 3 W, controller 2 W and sensors 3 W, or 7.4 A at 12 V [J1]. This is within the 100 W limit, the 10 A supply and the 10 A fuse. R15 is met. The TRL 2 figure of about 70 W and 6 A left out the heaters.

■ K. Cost (R12)

The BOM totals \$404 on 18 lines, \$104 over `budget_usd` of \$300 and \$4 over the \$400 recommended at TRL 2, which is still awaiting Amish [K1]. The increase from \$396 comes from the extra jacket panels, the 120 mm fan and the bubbler sleeve and trace heat. A core version without CO₂ (no SCD30 and no soda lime) would cost about \$337. R12 is **not met** against either figure.

■ L. Results against every requirement

Table 4. Results against CLR-REQ-001 v0.3 (tags point to the script output).

ID	Target	Value	Status
R1	10 to 40 °C in a room at 15 to 25 °C; lowest point stated up to 30 °C	8.9 °C lowest in a 25 °C room; 13.3 °C in a 30 °C room; 40 °C held [B4, B6]	Met
R2	20 to 85 % RH at 20 to 40 °C	Reached in 26 min or less, except 20 °C and 85 % RH in rooms above about 19 °C [C2, C3, C8, C9]	Not met
R3	±0.3 °C, ±2 % RH over 30 min	±0.02 °C, ±1.0 % RH (idealized model) [D1, D2]	Met
R4	±0.3 °C, ±2 % RH between bays	±0.18 °C at the EPA points, ±0.42 °C at 10 °C; ±0.8 % RH [E1, E2]	At risk
R5	0.2 °C, k = 2	0.14 °C (0.1 °C tolerance); 0.24 °C (0.2 °C tolerance) [F1]	At risk
R6	2 % RH, k = 2	2.0 % RH [F3]	At risk
R7	Zero below 2 µg/m³; 300 to 5 µg/m³ in 45 min	5 min clean-down, 0.17 µg/m³ floor; 28 min decay [G1, G2]	Met
R8	Transfer PM sensor collocated 30 days	No collocation site named	Not met
R9	Zero below 50 ppm; span 400 to 2,000 ppm	8 ppm floor; about 1,100 ppm added per liter of breath, to about 1,500 ppm from room air [H1]	Met
R10	Six heads 90 x 70 x 50 mm	Six bays, 244 mm clear [A2]	Met
R11	Sweep plus particle run in 8 h	5.6 h [I2]	Met
R12	\$300 in parts	\$404 [K1]	Not met
R13	600 x 500 mm, 400 mm high, 12 kg	600 x 500 x 374 mm, 13.4 kg [A3]	Not met (mass)
R14	CSV and per-sensor report	Software not written (beyond TRL 3)	Not verifiable at TRL 3
R15	No mains; fused 12 V; 100 W peak	89 W, 7.4 A [J1]	Met
R16	Cut-offs at 50 °C air and 70 °C hot side	Outer sink 50 °C at most in use [J2]	Met
R17	No toxic gases; smoke cleared through HEPA	By design; 5 min clean-down [G1]	Met
R18	Saw or laser cutter, drill, soldering iron	By design; no machined parts in the model	Met

Counts: met 10, at risk 3, not met 4, not verifiable at TRL 3 1 [L1].

■ Checks against the TRL 2 figures

Table 5. TRL 2 claims checked and corrected.

TRL 2 claim (CLR-PRC-001 v0.2, README)	TRL 3 value	Change
Heat leak about 1.0 W/K	0.82 W/K with door panel and full jacket; 1.17 W/K panel off	Jacket extended to all faces
Internal gains about 4 W	6.7 W	Corrected
10 °C not reachable in a 30 °C room; about 15 °C lowest	13.3 °C lowest in a 30 °C room; 8.9 °C in a 25 °C room	Corrected
Settling about 45 min per point; sweep plus particle run about 6 h	22 to 36 min to settle plus 15 min equilibration; 5.6 h	Corrected
Decay 300 to 5 µg/m ³ about 30 min	28 min	Confirmed
Peak power about 70 W; bus about 6 A	89 W; 7.4 A	Corrected (heaters added)
Size about 610 x 470 x 350 mm; mass about 10 kg	600 x 500 x 374 mm; 13.4 kg	Corrected
Parts about \$396	\$404	Corrected
Door with panel just above dew point at 40 °C, 85 % RH	1.2 K margin at 22 °C, 0.5 K at 15 °C	Confirmed
Humidity range met by estimate	Not met at 20 °C, 85 % RH above a 19 °C room	New finding